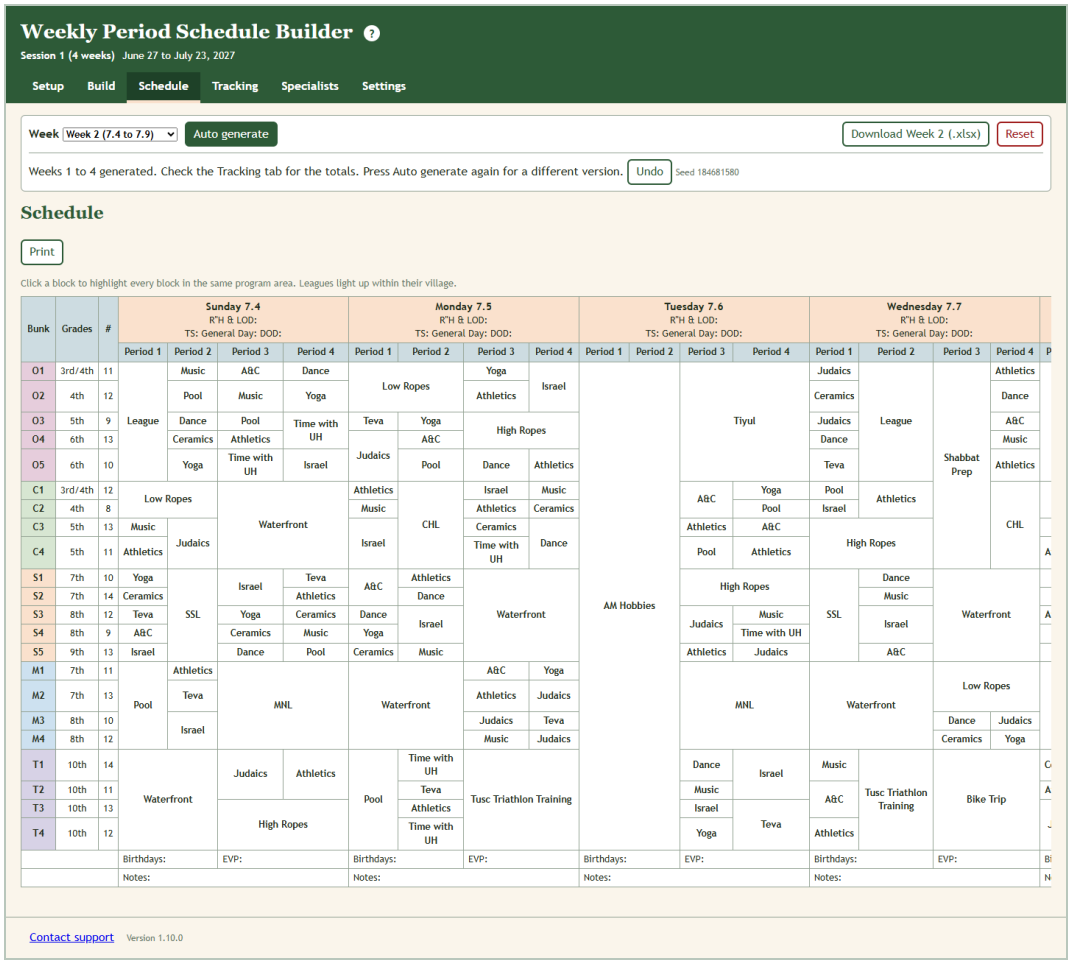
Weekly Period Schedule Builder

User's Manual

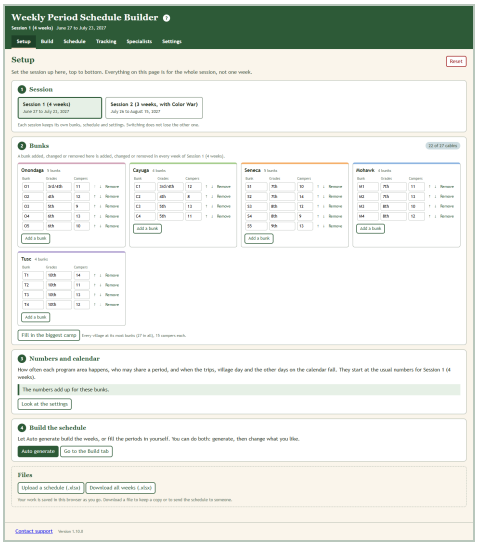


For version 1.11.1 of the app
Summer 2027: Session 1, June 27 to July 23. Session 2, July 26 to August 15.

Quick Start

This page gets you from an empty page to a finished session. Each step is explained in full later in the manual.

1. **Open the page.** The first time, a panel called **How to use this page** opens by itself. Read it or press **Close**. The **?** beside the title brings it back.
2. **You are on the Setup tab.** The page always opens there. It has four numbered steps, top to bottom.
3. **Step 1, Session.** Pick Session 1 (4 weeks) or Session 2 (3 weeks, with Color War).
4. **Step 2, Bunks.** The session starts with its bunks already in, village by village. Change names, grades and camper counts so they match this summer, and add or remove bunks. What you change here is changed in every week.
5. **Step 3, Numbers and calendar.** Setup says whether the numbers add up for these bunks. To move a trip or change a number, press **Look at the settings**.
6. **Step 4, Build the schedule.** Press **Auto generate**.
7. **Choose The whole session, week by week** and press **Generate**.
8. **Wait.** A bar shows how far it has got. Most runs take a few seconds, and a full camp of 27 bunks takes 2 minutes at the very most. You can keep using the page.
9. **Look at the Schedule tab** for each week, and the **Tracking** tab to see that the counts are fair. Not happy? Press **Auto generate** again for a different version, or **Undo**.
10. **Save it.** On Setup, at the bottom, press **Download all weeks (.xlsx)**. That file is your backup, and it is how you move the schedule to another computer.



The Setup tab, where the page opens: session, bunks, numbers, and on to building.

> **The one thing to remember:** the schedule lives in this browser on this computer. Download an Excel file whenever you have something worth keeping.

What is in this manual

1. What the app is, and where your work is kept
2. A tour of the page
3. How to do things by hand
4. Sessions, dates and the session calendar
5. Auto generate
6. The rules Auto generate follows
7. Settings reference
8. Saving, sharing and printing
9. Things that cannot be undone
10. Troubleshooting and questions
11. Known limits
12. Glossary

1. What the app is

The Weekly Period Schedule Builder holds the camp's period schedule: every bunk, four periods a day, Sunday to Friday, for each week of a session. You can fill it in by hand, or have the app build a week or a whole session for you and then change what you like.

It is for whoever makes the schedule: a director or a program staffer. If you are comfortable with a spreadsheet you will be comfortable here.

Where your work is kept

There is no login and nothing is sent anywhere. Everything you enter is saved by your web browser, on the computer you are using. That has three consequences.

- **Another computer, or another browser on the same computer, starts empty.** To move a schedule, download it as an Excel file and upload it on the other one.
- **Clearing your browser's site data erases the schedule.** So does using a private or incognito window, once it is closed.
- **The Excel file is your backup.** Download one before any big change, and at the end of each working session.

Session 1 and Session 2 are kept separately. Switching from one to the other does not lose either.

2. A tour of the page

The top of the page



The top of the page: the title, the session you are in, and the six tabs.

- **?** beside the title opens **How to use this page**, a short guide.
- Under the title is the session you are in, with its dates. You change session on the Setup tab.
- The six tabs: **Setup**, **Build**, **Schedule**, **Tracking**, **Specialists**, **Settings**.

Setup

Everything that is decided once for a session, in the order you do it. Nothing on this tab is about one week: it is all for the whole session.

1. **Session.** Two boxes, Session 1 and Session 2, each with its dates. The one you are in is outlined. Click the other to switch; each keeps its own bunks, schedule and settings.
2. **Bunks.** A box for each village with its bunks: name, grades, campers. The count at the top right, such as "22 of 27 cabins", is how many bunks the session has out of the cabins the camp has. Chapter 3 explains the buttons.
3. **Numbers and calendar.** One line saying whether the numbers add up for these bunks, and a button to the Settings tab.
4. **Build the schedule.** **Auto generate**, or **Go to the Build tab** to fill periods in by hand.

Reset, in red at the top right, clears the periods or puts the session back to its base template (chapter 3). At the bottom, under **Files**, are **Upload a schedule (.xlsx)** and **Download all weeks (.xlsx)**.

The week bar



The week bar, over the Build, Schedule and Tracking tabs.

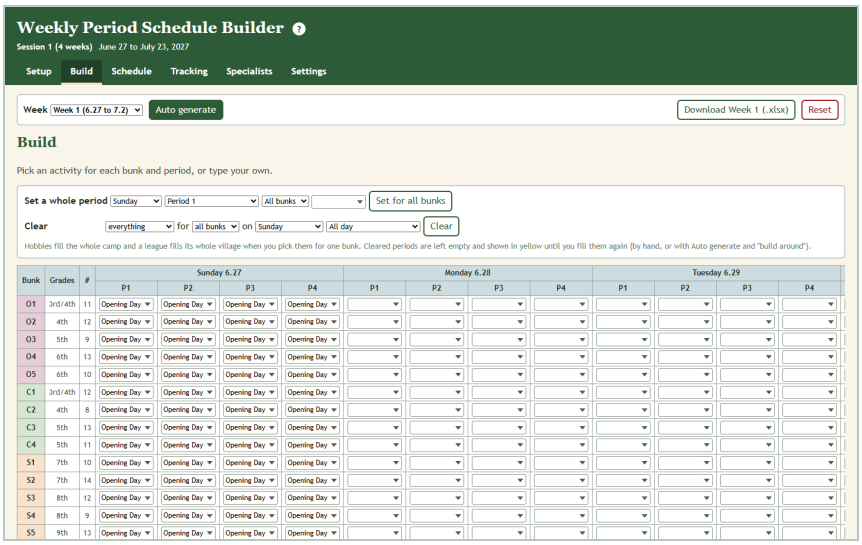
The three tabs that show one week at a time have a bar over them.

- **Week** picks the week you are looking at. Each week shows its dates.
- **Auto generate** builds the periods for you.
- **Download Week N (.xlsx)** saves the week on screen as an Excel file.
- **Reset** is the same Reset as on Setup.

While Auto generate is working, and just after, its progress and its result show in this bar on every tab.

Build

This is where the periods of one week are entered and changed. Each row is a bunk: its name, grades and number of campers, then a box for every period of the week. The day headings carry the dates. The bunks themselves are not changed here: that is done on Setup.

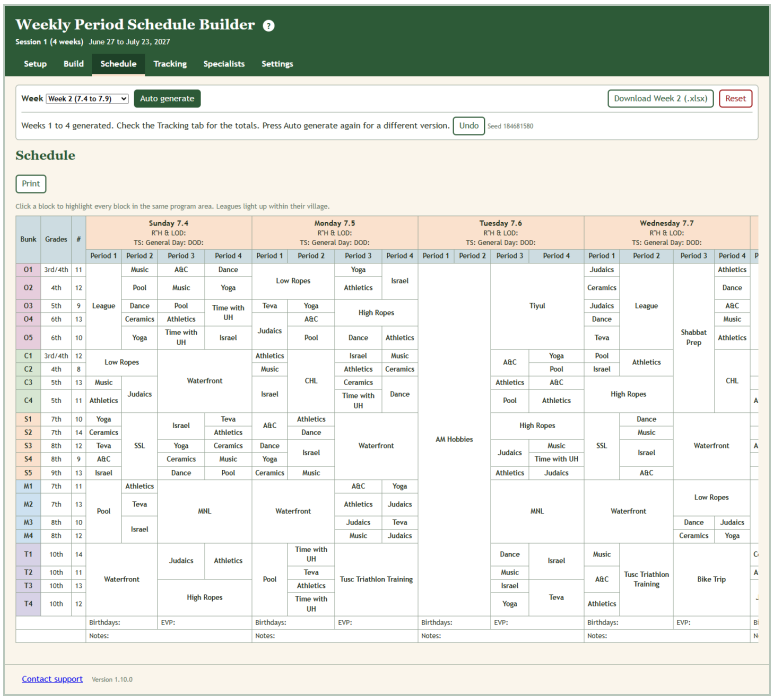


The Build tab for week 1 of Session 1, as the session starts. Sunday is Opening Day and has no periods.

Above the grid are two tools, **Set a whole period** and **Clear**, both explained in chapter 3.

Schedule

The finished grid, ready to print. Bunks doing the same thing in the same period are merged into one box. Click a box to light up every box in the same program area; a league lights up within its village. The **Print** button prints it.

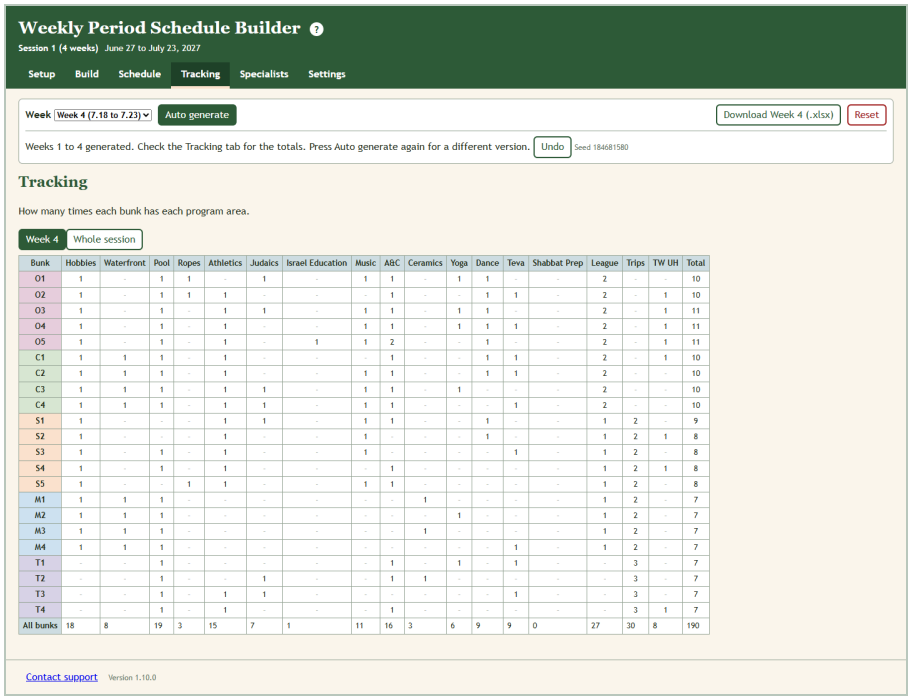


A generated week on the Schedule tab.

Tracking

How many times each bunk has each program area, for the week on screen and for the whole session. This is the place to check that things are fair. The last row, **All bunks**, adds everything up. Pointing at a number lights up its bunk and its program area, so it is easy to read across a wide table.

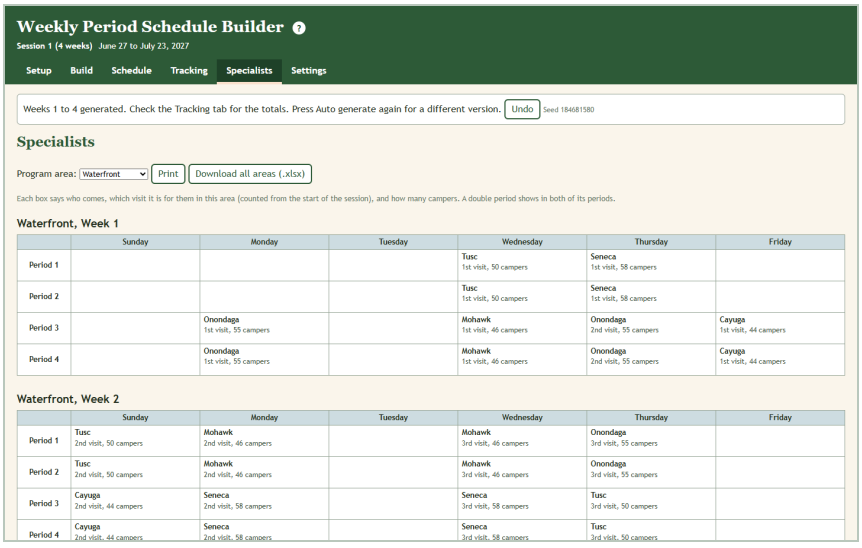
Light red means a bunk has fewer of something than the Settings tab asks for. It shows once the week on screen has been filled in (for the week) or every week of the session has (for the whole session). Point at a light red box to read the numbers: "O2 should have Ceramics 2 times in the session, and has it once."



The Tracking tab after a whole session was generated.

Specialists

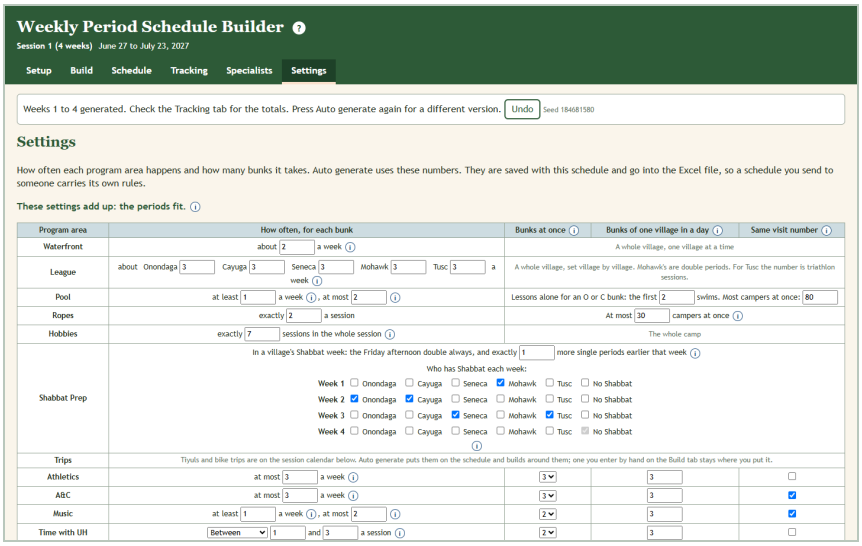
The schedule from one program area's side. Pick the area, and each week is a grid with days across and periods down. Each box says who comes, which visit it is for them in that area (counted from the start of the session), and how many campers. When a whole village comes it is written by name: Onondaga, Cayuga, Seneca, Mohawk, Tusc or Taste. Print it for the specialist.



The Specialists tab.

Settings

The numbers Auto generate works with: how often each program area happens, how many bunks it takes at once, who may share a period, and the session calendar. Chapter 7 lists every setting.

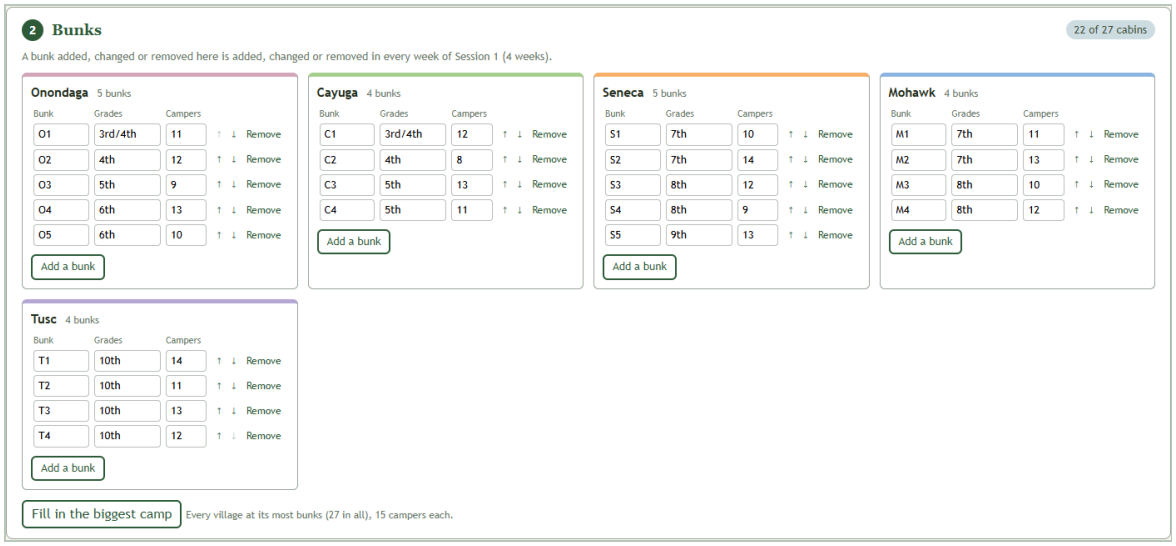


The top of the Settings tab.

3. How to do things by hand

Enter and edit bunks

Bunks are set on the **Setup** tab, in step 2. A bunk belongs to the session: what you do to it there is done in every week.



The bunks on the Setup tab, a box for each village.

- Type in a bunk's name, grades and campers boxes.
- **The first letter of the name is the village.** O is Onondaga, C is Cayuga, S is Seneca, M is Mohawk, T is Tusc. A bunk named O3 is in Onondaga. If you rename a bunk so that it starts with another letter, it moves to that village's box.
- **Grades** can be written the way you write them: 4th, 4th/5th, 9th. The app uses them to decide which bunks are close enough in age to share.
- **The camper count** matters at the pool, at ropes, at Yoga and at Ceramics, which go by how many campers fit.
- **Names that start with TC** (TC1, TC2 and so on) are Taste of CSL. See chapter 4.
- The arrows at the end of a row move a bunk up or down the list. **Remove** takes it out of every week, with everything on its rows. It asks first.
- **Add a bunk**, under a village, adds the next bunk of that village (after O5 comes O6) to every week, with a starting grade. Give it its camper count.

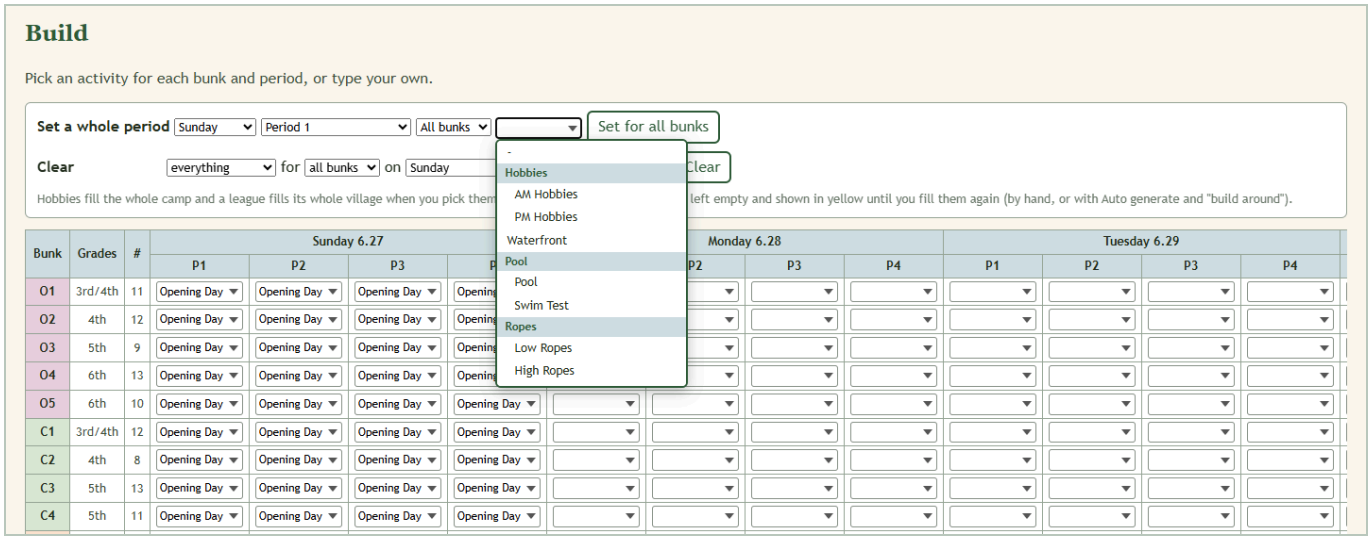
The camp has 27 cabins, so a session can have no more than 27 bunks, Taste of CSL included. At 27 the add buttons go grey.

Fill in the biggest camp brings every village up to its most bunks in every week. In Session 1 that is 5 Onondaga, 6 Cayuga, 6 Seneca, 6 Mohawk and 4 Tusc. In Session 2 it is 4 Taste of CSL, 3 Onondaga, 4 Cayuga, 6 Seneca, 6 Mohawk and 4 Tusc, because Taste of CSL's cabins come out of Onondaga's and Cayuga's. It also sets every bunk to 15 campers. The 15 is only a round number to plan with; nothing holds a bunk to it. It asks first.

> On the Build tab the bunk's name, grades and campers are shown and cannot be typed in. That is on purpose: a bunk is the same in every week, so it is changed in one place.

Fill a period by hand

Click a period's box and pick an activity from the list, or type to search. Activities are grouped by program area.



The activity list, open. Typing narrows it.

- **Write-ins.** Type anything that is not in the list and it is kept as written. A write-in is not counted on the Tracking tab.
- **Hobbies fill everyone.** Picking AM Hobbies or PM Hobbies in one bunk's box fills that half-day for every bunk.
- **A league fills its village.** Picking League, CHL, SSL, MNL or MAL fills that period for the whole village.
- **Some activities are always double periods:** Low Ropes, High Ropes, Waterfront, MNL and MAL fill both periods of the half-day you clicked in.
- Changing one box afterwards only changes that one box.

Set a whole period



The two tools above the grid: Set a whole period, and Clear.

Choose the day, the period (or all day, morning, afternoon), **All bunks** or one village, and the activity. Then press the button, which reads **Set for all bunks** or **Set for Onondaga**. This is the quick way to enter a trip.

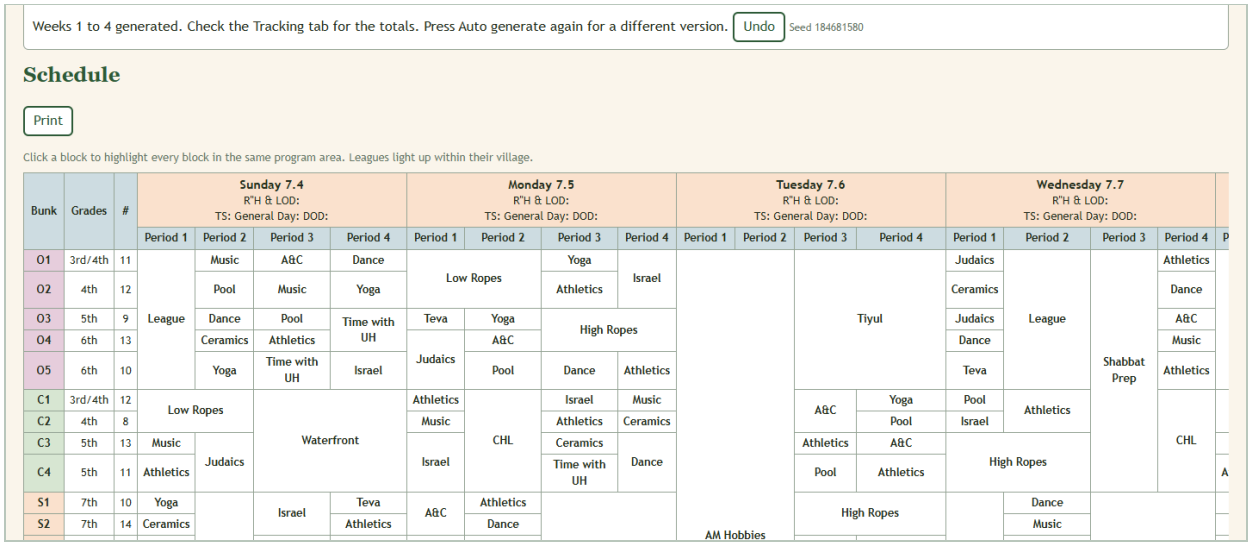
Enter a trip

Trips, Tiyuls and bike trips are on the session calendar and go onto the schedule by themselves (chapter 4). To put one somewhere else by hand, use **Set a whole period** with the activity Tiyul, Bike Trip or Trip for the village and the periods it is away. A trip you enter by hand stays where you put it, and the calendar does not add a second one for that village.

Clear an area, a bunk or a village

The Clear tool empties part of the week in one go: everything or one program area, for all bunks, one village or one bunk, on one day or the whole week, all day or one part of it. For example: Waterfront, for all bunks, on Tuesday, because of weather. It tells you how many periods it will empty and asks first.

The emptied periods turn **yellow** on the Build and Schedule tabs, so it is plain what still needs filling. A yellow period goes back to normal as soon as something is put in it. **Remove the yellow marks** takes the marks away and leaves the periods empty.



Bunk	Grades	#	Sunday 7.4 R"H & LOD: TS: General Day: DOD:				Monday 7.5 R"H & LOD: TS: General Day: DOD:				Tuesday 7.6 R"H & LOD: TS: General Day: DOD:				Wednesday 7.7 R"H & LOD: TS: General Day: DOD:				
			Period 1	Period 2	Period 3	Period 4	Period 1	Period 2	Period 3	Period 4	Period 1	Period 2	Period 3	Period 4	Period 1	Period 2	Period 3	Period 4	P
O1	3rd/4th	11		Music	A&C	Dance	Low Ropes		Yoga	Israel					Judaics			Athletics	
O2	4th	12		Pool	Music	Yoga			Athletics						Ceramics			Dance	
O3	5th	9	League	Dance	Pool	Time with UH	Teva	Yoga	High Ropes				Tiyul		Judaics	League	Shabbat Prep	A&C	
O4	6th	13		Ceramics	Athletics		Judaics	A&C							Dance			Music	
O5	6th	10		Yoga	Time with UH	Israel		Pool	Dance	Athletics					Teva			Athletics	
C1	3rd/4th	12	Low Ropes		Waterfront		Athletics	CHL	Israel	Music			A&C	Yoga	Pool	Athletics		CHL	
C2	4th	8					Music		Athletics	Ceramics				Pool	Israel				
C3	5th	13	Music	Judaics			Israel		Ceramics	Dance			Athletics	A&C	High Ropes				
C4	5th	11	Athletics						Time with UH				Pool	Athletics					A
S1	7th	10	Yoga		Israel	Teva	A&C	Athletics			AM Hobbies		High Ropes			Dance			
S2	7th	14	Ceramics			Athletics		Dance								Music			

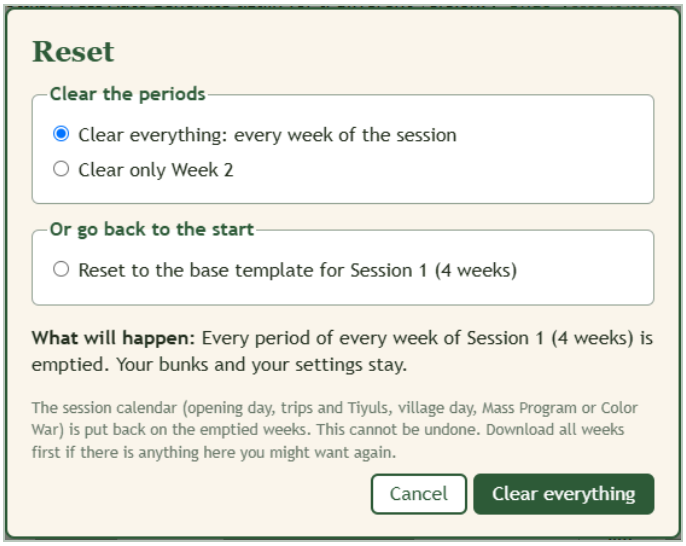
After clearing Waterfront on Tuesday: the emptied periods are yellow.

Reset

Reset, in red at the top of the Setup tab and in the week bar, is the one way to wipe the slate. It opens a box with three choices and says, in words, what the one you picked will do.

- **Clear everything: every week of the session**. Every period of every week is emptied. Your bunks and your settings stay.
- **Clear only Week N**. Every period of the week on screen is emptied. The other weeks, your bunks and your settings are not touched.
- **Reset to the base template**. The session goes back to exactly how it starts: its own bunks, its own settings and calendar, and no periods filled in. Bunks you added and settings you changed are gone.

In each case the session calendar is put back on the emptied weeks: opening day, the trips and Tiyuls, village day, Mass Program or Color War.



The Reset box says what will happen before it does anything.

> Reset cannot be undone. Download all weeks first if there is anything on the page you might want again.

Build around what you entered

Anything you put in by hand can be kept while the app fills the rest. Enter what you want fixed, press **Auto generate**, and choose **Keep what is there and build around it**. Only the empty periods are filled. This is also how you refill yellow periods after a Clear.

4. Sessions, dates and the calendar

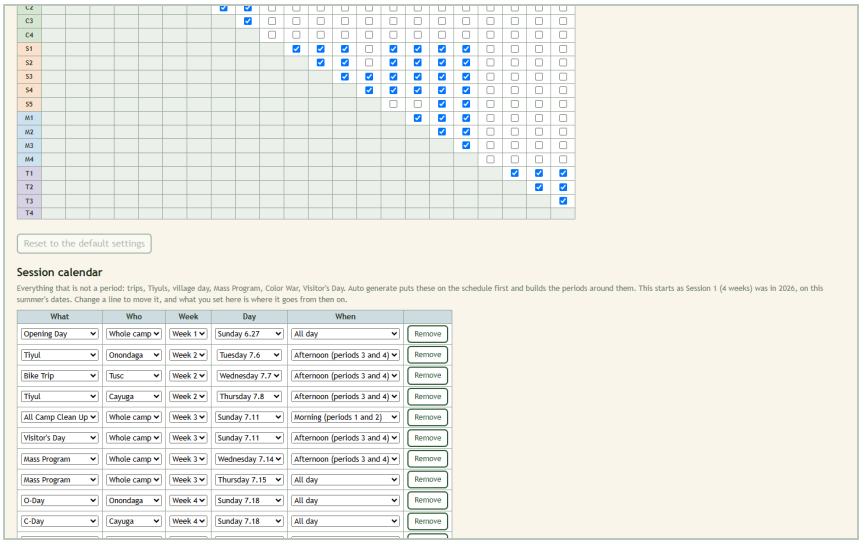
Two sessions

	Session 1	Session 2
Length	4 weeks	3 weeks
Dates, summer 2027	June 27 to July 23	July 26 to August 15
Opening day	Sunday June 27. No periods; they start Monday.	Monday July 26. No periods; they start Tuesday.
Bunks it starts with	5 Onondaga, 4 Cayuga, 5 Seneca, 4 Mohawk, 4 Tusc	3 Onondaga, 4 Cayuga, 5 Seneca, 5 Mohawk, 4 Tusc, and Taste of CSL (TC1 to TC4) in week 1
Special to it	Visitor's Day, Mass Program, village day on the last Sunday, the three-day Tusc bike trip, Hobby Culmination and Packing Time	Color War, the Tusc Triathlon, village day for everyone including Tusc

Each session keeps its own bunks, schedule and settings. A session you have never opened starts from its template: its bunks, its numbers, and its calendar already on the schedule. The grades and camper counts it starts with are placeholders: change them to this summer's.

The session calendar

The calendar is everything that is not a period: opening day, the Tiyuls, the bike trips, village day (O-Day, C-Day and so on), Mass Program, Color War, Visitor's Day and the clean up. It starts as the session was in 2026, on this summer's dates.



The session calendar, at the bottom of the Settings tab.

Each line says **what**, **who** (the whole camp or one village), which **week**, which **day**, and **when** (all day, morning, afternoon, or one period). To move something, change its line. You can also remove a line or add one.

- **Add a line** adds a new item for you to fill in.
- **Back to the Session 1 calendar** (or Session 2) undoes your changes to the calendar.
- **Put the calendar on the schedule now** writes it onto every week. It only fills empty periods. Auto generate does the same thing before it builds a week.

> Moving a line does not move something that is already on the schedule. Clear the old one on the Build tab, then press **Put the calendar on the schedule now**.

What the calendar holds to start with

Session 1	When
Opening Day	Week 1, Sunday, all day
Onondaga Tiyul	Week 2, Tuesday afternoon
Tusc mini bike trip	Week 2, Wednesday afternoon
Cayuga Tiyul	Week 2, Thursday afternoon
All Camp Clean Up, then Visitor's Day	Week 3, Sunday morning, then afternoon
Mass Program	Week 3, Wednesday afternoon and all of Thursday
Village day (O-Day, C-Day, S-Day, M-Day)	Week 4, Sunday, all day
Tusc bike trip	Week 4, Sunday, Monday and Tuesday, all day
Seneca Tiyul	Week 4, Monday afternoon into Tuesday morning
Mohawk Tiyul	Week 4, Tuesday afternoon into Wednesday morning

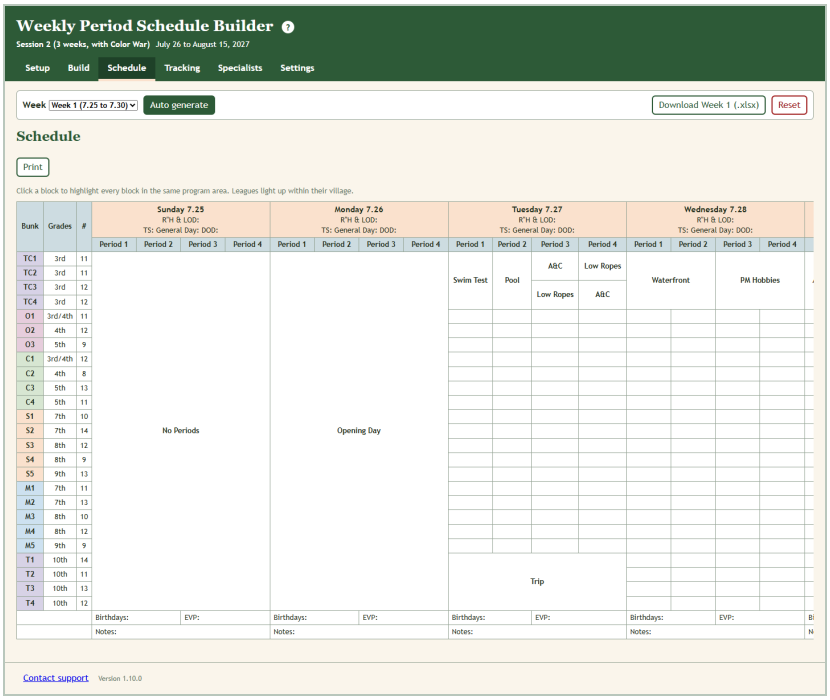
Session 2	When
No Periods, then Opening Day	Week 1, Sunday, then Monday, all day
Tusc trip	Week 1, Tuesday, all day
Taste of CSL's week	Week 1, Tuesday to Friday
Onondaga and Cayuga Tiyul	Week 2, Sunday afternoon
Seneca Tiyul	Week 2, Monday afternoon into Tuesday morning
Mohawk Tiyul	Week 2, Tuesday afternoon into Wednesday morning
Village day for every village	Week 2, Thursday, all day
All Camp Clean Up	Week 3, Sunday, period 3
Color War	Week 3, Monday and Tuesday, all day

Tusc Triathlon (the whole camp)	Week 3, Thursday afternoon

Taste of CSL

Bunks named TC1, TC2 and so on are Taste of CSL. They are in camp for week 1 of Session 2 only.

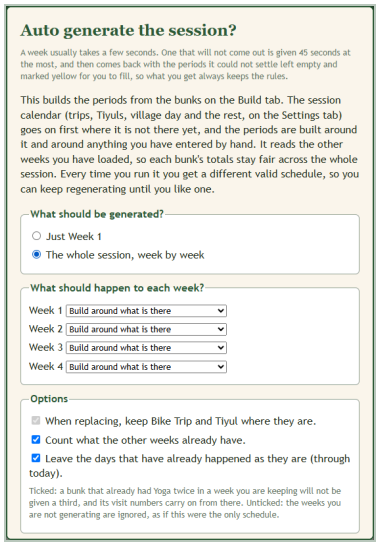
- They have no league, and nothing of theirs is on the Settings tab: not in the numbers, and not on the calendar table.
- Their week is set, copied from 2026. The first half of the TC bunks follows one schedule and the second half the other; the two differ only on Tuesday afternoon.
- Auto generate leaves their week exactly as it is.
- Nobody else is put at a program area in a period Taste of CSL has it. They may all be there together.
- They are a village of their own, called Taste. They are not part of Tusc, even though the name starts with a T.
- Their cabins come out of Onondaga's and Cayuga's, which is why those two villages start smaller in Session 2.
- You can have more or fewer than four. Add or remove them in the Taste box on the Setup tab.



Session 2, week 1, as the session starts: no periods Sunday, Opening Day Monday, Taste of CSL's week filled in, Tusc on its trip Tuesday.

5. Auto generate

Auto generate builds the periods for the session's bunks. The button is in step 4 of the Setup tab and in the week bar. It puts the session calendar on first, where it is not there yet, and builds around it and around anything you entered by hand. It reads the other weeks of the session, so each bunk's totals stay fair across the whole session.



The Auto generate dialog, set to the whole session.

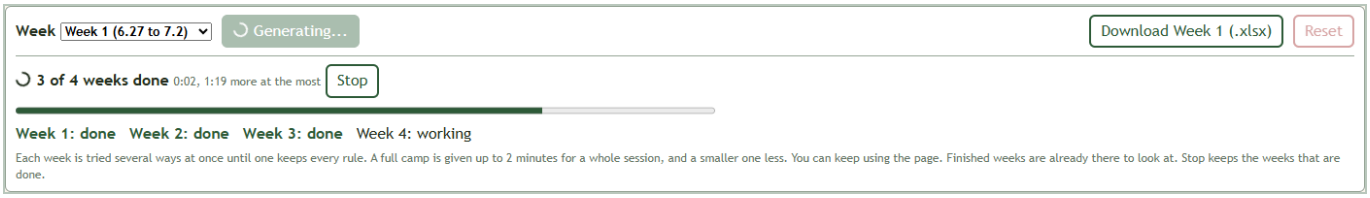
What the dialog asks

- **What should be generated?** Just Week N, or The whole session, week by week.
- **For one week that already has activities:** Keep what is there and build around it (only the empty periods are filled) or Replace what is there (the week is cleared first).
- **For the whole session, a choice for each week:**
  - Lock: leave it exactly as it is
  - Build around what is there
  - Regenerate: clear it and build it again

  A week that is already filled in starts as Lock.
- **When replacing, keep Bike Trip and Tiyul where they are.** On to start with. Everything on the session calendar is kept the same way.
- **Count what the other weeks already have.** On to start with. A bunk that already had Yoga twice in a week you are keeping is not given a third, and its visit numbers carry on from there. Off, the weeks you are not generating are ignored.
- **Leave the days that have already happened as they are (through today).** On to start with. Once the session is under way, generating a week again only touches the days still to come, and what already happened still counts toward the totals.

The session is the one picked on the Setup tab, not something the dialog asks.

While it runs



The progress panel: the bar, weeks done, the time so far and the most it can still take, and Stop.

- It works in the background. You can switch tabs and weeks, look at Tracking, and download.
- **The bar moves with the clock.** A week that is done counts in full, and the week being worked on fills in as its time goes by. So the bar keeps moving, jumps ahead when a week comes out early, and is full when the run is over.
- Beside the time so far it says the most the run can still take, such as "1:19 more at the most". Most runs finish long before that.
- Each week appears on the page as soon as it is done.
- The weeks being generated can be looked at but not changed until the run is over.
- **Stop** keeps the weeks that are already done and leaves the rest as they were.

How long it takes

A whole session has a time limit: **2 minutes for a full camp of 27 bunks**, and less for a smaller camp, down to 75 seconds for 21 bunks or fewer. One week on its own gets a quarter of that (a third in Session 2).

Most runs are far quicker. In our own tests on one computer, Session 1 as it starts (22 bunks) took a few seconds, the full 27-bunk Session 1 took 8, 16 and 19 seconds in three runs, and the full Session 2 took 7 seconds twice. A slower computer will take longer.

The app tries a week several ways at once and keeps the first one that keeps every rule. If none does, it tries again, without saying anything except "try 2" in the panel. A week that comes out early leaves its time to the weeks after it.

When a week will not come out

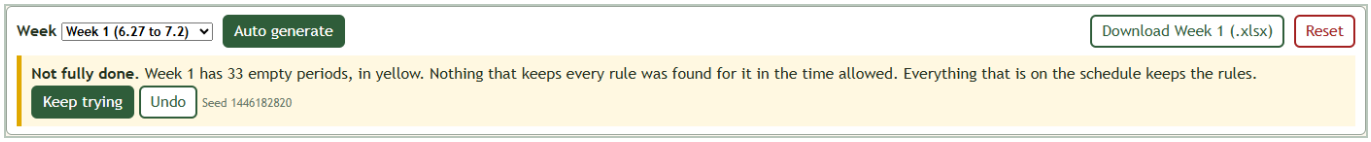
If a week uses up its time and no version of it keeps every rule, the app hands back the best one it found, and does two things to it.

First, it will go one over a limit before it leaves a period empty. A limit on how many bunks are at an area at once, or on how many bunks of one village go there in a day, may be passed by one. It is only ever bunks who are all allowed to share with each other, by the sharing choices and the grid on the Settings tab (so bunks of one village, or Onondaga with Cayuga and Seneca with Mohawk where those mix). Who may share is never overridden. Every place this happened is **outlined in orange** on the Schedule and Build tabs and listed above the Schedule grid with the day, the period and what is over, such as "O1, O2, O3 are 3 at Teva on Monday period 2, and the most is 2". The line after the run counts them by week. Change such a period by hand and its mark goes.

These never go over, whatever happens: a fourth bunk at Athletics, a first visit to Ceramics, the pool's camper limit, the same thing twice in a day or two days running, and period 4 into period 1.

Second, anything else that breaks a rule is emptied and given another activity where one fits. If every period ends up filled, the week is done like any other.

If some periods are left with nothing that fits, they are **empty and marked yellow**, and the line after the run says so in place of saying the weeks were generated:

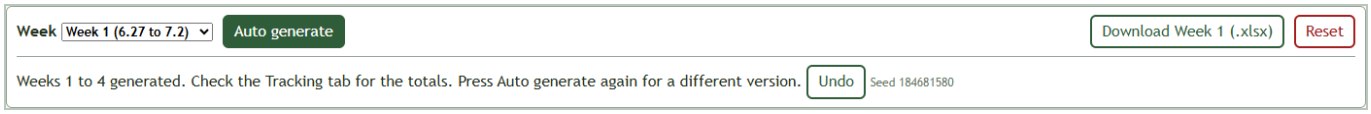


"Not fully done" names the week and says how many periods are empty.

- Everything that is on the schedule still keeps the rules. Only the yellow periods are missing something.
- **Keep trying** puts that week, the week before it and the weeks after it back as they were, and generates them again. The week before goes again because what it used up is the usual reason the next one cannot be finished.
- Or fill the yellow periods by hand, or change a setting and generate again.

In our tests of this version with the numbers the app starts with, Session 1 and Session 2 as they start came out complete every time, in a few seconds. A full camp of 27 bunks at 15 campers each did not always: four runs of the full Session 1 left 0, 1, 3 and 6 empty periods, and two runs of the full Session 2 left 0 and 7. Smaller bunks make more room, because two can go together where two of 15 cannot. If the Settings tab says "Unlikely to work" or "Not possible", expect it.

Afterwards



After a run: what was generated, and Undo.

- **Generate again as often as you like.** Every run gives a different schedule.
- **Undo** puts back every week the run made. It leaves alone anything you changed in other weeks meanwhile.
- **Undo has limits.** It only undoes the last run. It goes away as soon as you change a period by hand, upload a file, switch session, or reload the page.

6. The rules it follows

These are the rules a generated week keeps. They are written here in plain words; the app does not list them on screen.

For every bunk

- Every period has something in it. The one exception is the last Friday of Session 1, which is departure and stays empty.
- No program area twice in one day.
- No program area two days in a row. Trips do not count, and Friday into Sunday does not count.
- Nothing in period 4 and again in period 1 the next morning.
- Athletics and A&C are single periods, never a double.
- Athletics and A&C stay within two of each other over the session, and every bunk gets A&C.

For villages

- Waterfront, league, Shabbat Prep, the swim test, Tiyul and the bike trip are for the whole village at once.
- Waterfront is a double period, morning or afternoon, one village at a time.
- Nobody goes to Waterfront before the swim test. In week 1 that means not on the first morning with periods, and not before the village has swum. Mohawk takes its test during General Swim on the first day, so its Waterfront starts on the second.
- Only so many bunks of one village go to an area in one day. The number is a setting.

Sharing a period

- Only so many bunks are at an area at once, and at some areas only so many campers. The numbers are settings. Athletics takes three bunks at the most and aims for two; A&C takes two.
- Bunks only share with bunks they are allowed to be with (chapter 7, Who may share a period).
- Bunks that share are on the same visit number, so a bunk on its second Teva is not put with a bunk on its first. Athletics and Time with UH are the exceptions to start with.
- Time with UH and Judaics: two bunks, of the same village.
- Ropes, Yoga and Ceramics go by campers: bunks of a village go together as long as their campers add up to no more than the limit. Two bunks may always be at ropes together. Two bunks of a village may be at Ceramics together on their second visit, when they are glazing; ideally nobody is at A&C then.

The pool

- One group at the pool in a period.
- An Onondaga or Cayuga bunk's first swims are lessons, one bunk alone. How many is a setting.
- Onondaga and Cayuga never swim together. Tusc always swims as a whole village. Seneca and Mohawk swim together only at the same age.
- Tusc's triathlon training is never in a period when someone is swimming.

The calendar and Shabbat

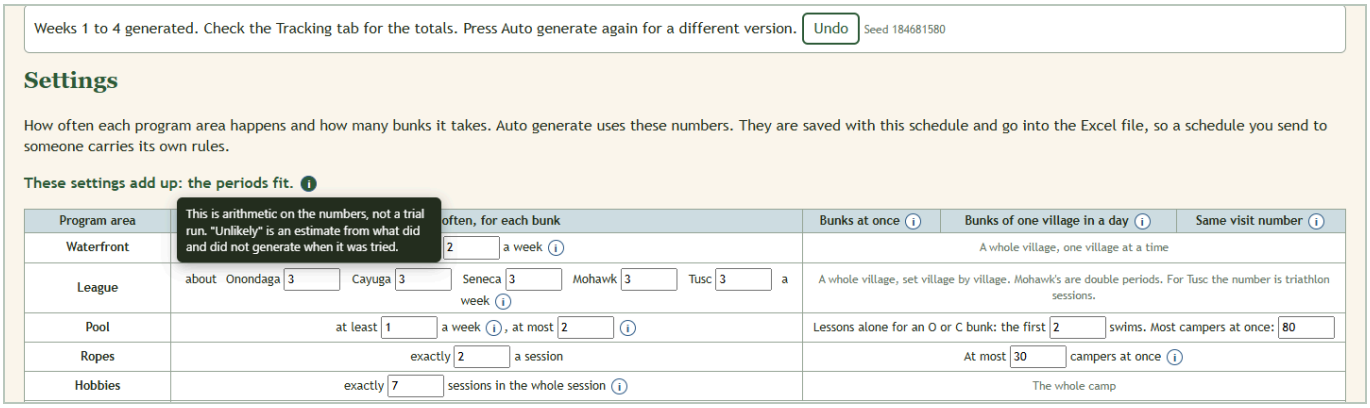
- Nothing on the session calendar is ever moved, and nothing you entered by hand is changed unless you chose to replace the week.
- A village has Shabbat Prep on Friday afternoon of its Shabbat week, and the extra single periods you set.
- No bunk has Music or Judaics while any village is at Shabbat Prep, because those specialists run it.
- Low Ropes comes before High Ropes.
- Music is once a week where it fits and every other week at the least, and never more than four times in a session.

Fairness, and short weeks

- "Twice a week" means on average over the session. A week the calendar cuts short, such as the week with Mass Program, gets fewer Waterfront and league periods.
- When the calendar leaves a bunk a good deal less room than an ordinary session, it gets as many visits as fit. It is not treated as a failure.
- Neighbours in a village are given the same areas each week, so they stay on the same visit and can keep going together.
- In week 4 of Session 1, which has the least room, two things are looser: A&C partners need not be on the same visit, and a bunk may have one more Time with UH.
- Ceramics, Judaics and Israel have the fewest places, so they are given their periods first each week. A visit that has no period that week is put off to a later week.
- Waterfront and league may go one over their number in a week where a half-day is open and the village has room.

7. Settings reference

Settings are saved with the session and go into the Excel file. A small **i** beside a number says more when you point at it.



Pointing at an **i** opens a short explanation.

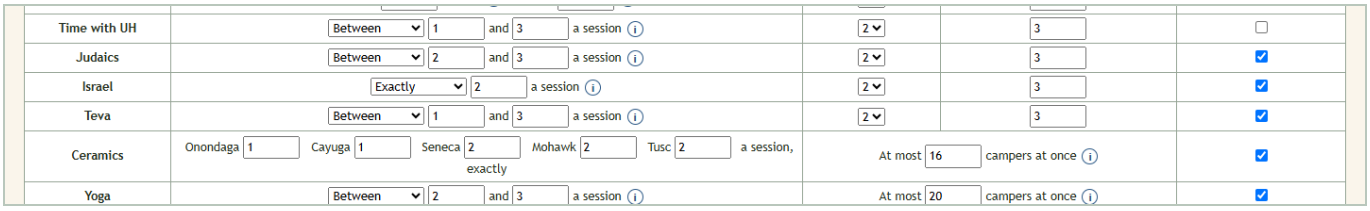
The check at the top

The page does the arithmetic on your numbers as you change them. It says one of four things.

It says	It means
These settings add up: the periods fit.	Nothing to do.
Will come up short.	A schedule comes out, but the calendar leaves less room than the numbers ask for, so some bunks will end the session short of a few visits. Nothing has to change. Lower a number if you would rather choose what gives way. A village that is only a period or two short, which is what a lot of league does, is not mentioned.
Unlikely to work.	It adds up on paper, but settings this tight did not generate when they were tried. It says what to try.
Not possible.	The periods do not add up. It says what to try.

How many times a session: one menu

Time with UH, Judaics, Israel, Teva, Yoga and any area you add say how often the same way: a menu, and the number or numbers that go with it.



The same menu on each of these rows.

Choice	What every bunk gets
Exactly _	That many, no more. "Exactly 0" stops the area being used.
At least _	That many, and more when there are periods to fill.
No more than _	No set number. The area only fills periods that would otherwise be Athletics or A&C, up to that many for a bunk. Some bunks may get none.
Between _ and _	The first number, and the area fills periods up to the second.
Leftover	No number at all. The area fills whatever periods the others leave, the way Athletics and A&C do.

Whichever you pick, when the calendar leaves a bunk too few periods for everything, the bunk ends short of something. Changing the choice keeps the number that was there where it still makes sense.

> The other rows do not have this menu. Waterfront, league, the pool, Music, Athletics and A&C are set by the week, Ropes and Hobbies are an exact number, and Dance and Ceramics are an exact number for each village.

Every setting

Setting	What it controls	Starts at	A reason to change it
Waterfront, about _ a week	Waterfront blocks a village has in a week, on average.	2	The lake is closed part of the summer.
League, about _ a week, for each village	League periods a week. Mohawk's are double periods. For Tusc the number is triathlon sessions. Taste of CSL has no league.	2, and 3 for Mohawk (2 for everyone in Session 2)	One village plays more or less often.
Pool, at least _ a week	Swims each bunk gets every week.	1	The pool is closed: set 0.
Pool, at most _	The most swims in a week. A second swim is given a whole village at a time, to the village that has swum least.	2	Keep everyone to one swim.
Lessons alone, the first _ swims	How many of an Onondaga or Cayuga bunk's first swims are one bunk alone.	2	More or fewer lessons this year.
Pool, most campers at once	The most campers in the water together, unless it is one whole village. This limit is never passed.	75	Fewer lifeguards.
Ropes, exactly _ a session	Ropes blocks each bunk gets. Low first, then High, each a double period.	2	The course is closed for part of the session.

Ropes, at most _ campers at once, or _ bunks whatever their campers	Bunks of a village go together up to this many campers, and the second number of bunks may always go together however many campers they are. One group is at ropes in a half-day, so these decide how many bunks can have ropes in a session.	25 campers, or 2 bunks (3 bunks in Session 2)	The Settings tab says ropes does not fit for everyone: let more bunks go together.
Hobbies, exactly _ sessions in the whole session	Hobby half-days for the whole camp, in total. Every week gets its Friday morning first, then a midweek one, then Sunday mornings.	7	More or fewer hobby days.
Shabbat Prep, exactly _ more single periods	Single periods of Shabbat Prep earlier in a village's Shabbat week, on top of the Friday afternoon double.	1	A village needs more or less time to prepare.
Who has Shabbat each week	Tick the village or villages for each week, or No Shabbat.	Session 1: week 1 Mohawk, week 2 Onondaga and Cayuga, week 3 Seneca and Tusc	This summer's turns are different.
Athletics and A&C, at most _ a week	The most of each a bunk has in a week. They fill whatever periods the other areas leave.	3	Rarely.
Music, at least _ a week, at most _	The weekly Music, and how far it may go to fill a period. A bunk may go without in a week where it will not fit, as long as it has Music every other week, and never has more than four in a session.	1 and 2	The Music specialist is part time.
Time with UH (the menu)	Time with the Unit Head.	Between 2 and 4 (1 and 3 in Session 2)	Unit heads want more or less time with bunks.
Judaics, Israel, Teva, Yoga (the menu)	How many times a session each bunk goes.	Judaics between 2 and 3. Israel exactly 2. Teva between 2 and 4. Yoga between 1 and 2.	A specialist is hired, leaves, or is part time. To stop using an area, set it to exactly 0.
Ceramics, by village, a session, exactly	Ceramics is set village by village. A piece is made on one visit and glazed on the next, so the number that makes sense for a village is 2 or 0.	2 for every village	The Settings tab says Ceramics will come up short: choose which villages go.

Ceramics, at most _ campers at once	Ceramics goes by campers, like ropes. A bunk bigger than the number goes alone. On a second visit two bunks of a village may go together over the number. On a first visit this limit is never passed.	16	The studio holds more or fewer.
Dance, by village, a session, exactly	Dance is set village by village.	Onondaga 3, Cayuga 2, Seneca 3, Mohawk 1, Tusc 2	A village wants more or less Dance.
Yoga, at most _ campers at once	Yoga goes by campers, like ropes: bunks of a village go together up to this many.	16	The Yoga space holds more or fewer.
Bunks at once, and campers	How many bunks an area takes in one period, and beside it the most campers there at once: two bunks only go together when they have no more campers between them than that. 0 campers means no limit in campers. Athletics can be set to 1, 2 or 3 bunks and never more.	Athletics 3, A&C 2, the others 2. Campers: Judaics 25, Israel 32, Teva 32, Dance 40.	A second specialist, or a bigger space.
Bunks of one village in a day	The most bunks of one village an area sees in one day.	3	An area that should not see the same village all day.
Same visit number	Ticked: bunks that share a period there must be on the same visit. Unticked: any visit will do.	Ticked for everything except Athletics and Time with UH	An area where it does not matter who has been before.
In the last week of the session, bunks that share a period may be one visit apart	A little slack in the last week, when there is the least room to line bunks up.	Off	The last week keeps coming back with gaps.

Session 2 is three weeks with Color War in it, so a few of its numbers start a little lower than Session 1's: Judaics and Israel between 1 and 2, Teva and Time with UH between 1 and 3, Dance one fewer for most villages, and league twice a week for Mohawk too. Ropes is twice, with three bunks together. Tusc is the same campers as in Session 1 and has had Low and High Ropes there, so in Session 2 it gets one more, High, only when a half-day is going spare. Ceramics stays twice for everybody: there is not always room, and the Settings tab says so and leaves the choice of who goes to you.

Add or remove a program area

When someone is hired for something new, such as archery or martial arts, type its name in the last row of the table, choose its numbers, and press **Add**. It becomes an activity you can pick on the Build tab, a column on the Tracking tab, a tab in the specialist schedules, and Auto generate gives it to every bunk as single periods. Up to six can be added. An added area has a **Remove** button beside its name. To stop using an area that came with the app, set it to exactly 0.

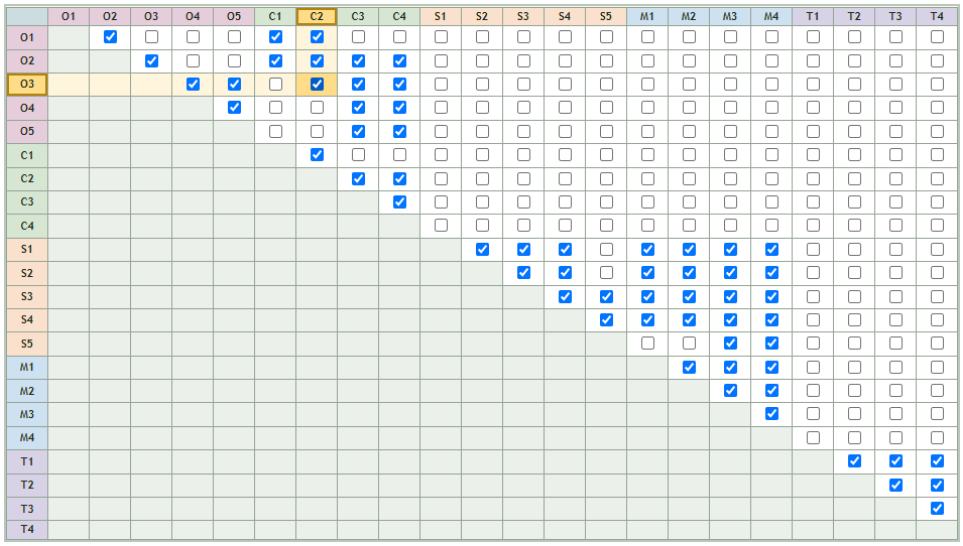
Who may share a period

Three choices cover most camps:

- **Inside a village:** only the bunk next to it in the list, or any bunk of the village. Starts at any bunk of the village.
- **Paired villages (Onondaga with Cayuga, Seneca with Mohawk):** may mix, or never mix. Starts at may mix.
- **Grades:** the same grade, within one grade, or any grades. Starts at within one grade.

These are for the areas where bunks may be together. Athletics takes any bunks, Tusc bunks always share with each other, and the pool keeps its own rules whatever is chosen here.

Advanced: customize sharing opens a grid with a box for every pair of bunks. A ticked box means the two may share. Tick or untick any pair; a box you change is outlined, and it stays that way whatever the three choices are set to. Pointing at a box lights up the two bunks it is for. **Undo the changes on the grid** puts every pair back.



The sharing grid. The two bunks of the box under the pointer are lit up.

> The grid goes by bunk name. A bunk that is renamed starts again from the three choices.

A full camp

The biggest Session 1 camp is 5 Onondaga, 6 Cayuga, 6 Seneca, 6 Mohawk and 4 Tusc: 27 bunks, every cabin. The numbers the app starts with are the ones that many bunks need: 3 bunks of a village a day at every area, and any two bunks of a village within a grade may share. There is nothing to switch on.

If you lower those and a village has six bunks or more, the Settings tab shows a button, **Use the suggested settings**, and the Auto generate dialog offers the same thing, ticked, to put them back.

A full camp of full bunks is short of room, and the Settings tab says so where it applies. With 15 campers in a bunk, only one bunk fits at Yoga or at a first Ceramics visit, and two bunks of 15 are over the 25 at Judaics, so expect some bunks to end the session a visit short at each. Ropes has just enough half-days for everyone twice with no room to spare. And with A&C at two bunks, a handful of periods in the first

week may have nothing that fits: those are where the app goes one over a limit, or, failing that, leaves a yellow period. Smaller bunks ease all of this, because two can go together.

Reset to the default settings

Reset to the default settings puts every number back to what the session starts with. It does not touch the schedule. To put the schedule back as well, use **Reset**.

8. Saving, sharing and printing

Download

Button	Where it is	What is in the file
Download Week N (.xlsx)	The week bar	The week on screen on a tab named "Week N", a Tracking tab for that week, and the settings tabs.
Download all weeks (.xlsx)	Setup, under Files	One tab for each week that has bunks, a "Whole Session Tracking" tab, and the settings tabs.
Download all areas (.xlsx)	The Specialists tab	One tab for each program area, laid out like the Specialists tab. This file is for reading and printing; it cannot be uploaded back.

The settings tabs are **Settings** (one row per program area), **Main areas** (Waterfront, league, pool and the rest, and which session the file is from), **Sharing**, and, when you changed the calendar, **Calendar**.

Upload

Upload a schedule (.xlsx), on the Setup tab under Files, reads every "Week N" tab in a file, however many there are, and tells you which weeks it will load and which it will overwrite before it does anything. A file with settings in it brings them along and replaces the ones on screen. A file that was saved from the other session is loaded into that session, and the session on screen is kept as it is.

What comes back, and what does not

Kept through a download and upload	Not kept
Bunks: names, grades, camper counts. Every period, write-ins included. Day details. All settings. The session calendar, when it was changed. Which session it is.	The yellow marks left by the Clear tool. The chance to Undo. The Tracking and Specialists tabs are worked out again from the schedule, not read from the file.

You can edit the file in Excel or Google Sheets and upload it again. Keep the tab names and the header rows as they are.

Printing

The Schedule tab has a **Print** button. For a specialist, either print the Specialists tab from your browser, or download **Download all areas (.xlsx)** there and print the tab you want from Excel. Landscape paper suits both.

9. Things that cannot be undone

Each of these asks before it acts, except where noted. None of them can be taken back afterwards. **Download all weeks first** if there is anything on the page you might want again.

Button	What it does
Reset	Empties every period of the week on screen or of the whole session and puts the session calendar back on, or puts the whole session back to its base template, bunks and settings included. It tells you what it will do first.
Remove, beside a bunk on the Setup tab	Takes the bunk out of every week, with everything on its rows. It asks first.
Clear, on the Build tab	Empties the periods you described. They are marked yellow, so you can see where, but what was in them is gone.
Upload a schedule	Overwrites the weeks that are in the file, and the settings if the file has them.
Fill in the biggest camp	Adds bunks to every week and sets every bunk's camper count to 15. The counts that were there are gone.
Add a bunk	Adds a bunk to every week of the session. It does not ask first. Remove takes it out again.
Reset to the default settings	Puts every setting back, including a changed calendar and the sharing grid.
Auto generate, with Replace or Regenerate	Clears the week before building it. This one has **Undo**, until you change something by hand.

10. Troubleshooting and questions

It says "Not fully done", and a week has yellow, empty periods.

The app could not find a version of that week that keeps every rule inside its time, so it emptied the periods that broke one and refilled the ones it could. Press **Keep trying** for another go at that week and the ones around it, fill the yellow periods by hand, or loosen a setting. Look at the top of the Settings tab first: if it says "Unlikely to work" or "Not possible", the numbers are the reason.

Some periods are outlined in orange.

To finish the week, the app went one bunk over a limit there. The list above the Schedule grid says where and what. Nothing else about those periods breaks a rule, and the bunks there are all allowed to share. Leave them, or move one of the bunks by hand; the mark goes when the period is changed.

A number on the Tracking tab is light red.

That bunk has fewer of that area than the Settings tab asks for. Point at it to see the numbers. Generate again, fill it by hand, or lower the number if it was never going to fit.

The Settings tab says "Will come up short".

That is information, not an error. The calendar leaves less room than the numbers ask for, so some bunks will end the session a visit or two short of something. Auto generate fits in as many as it can. Session 1 as it starts does not say it. Session 2 says it for Ceramics from the start, and a full camp says it for more.

Not every bunk got ropes twice.

The camp has one ropes course, and one group is there in a half-day. A session only has so many half-days, so there is a limit to how many groups can go, however the schedule is arranged. When the bunks and the ropes settings ask for more than that, the Settings tab says so at the top: "Ropes will not come out for everyone", or "Ropes is not possible for everyone", with the number of half-days and the number of groups. It also says what to try: usually more campers at once at ropes, so more bunks go together.

When ropes does fit, every bunk gets it as often as the setting says. When it does not, everyone gets a first turn before anyone gets a second. Session 1 as it starts fits. Session 2 fits with three bunks together and Tusc going only when there is room. The biggest Session 1 camp, 27 bunks at 15 campers each, does not fit two bunks at a time; at 45 campers at once it does.

The Settings tab says "Not possible" or "Unlikely to work".

The numbers ask for more than there are periods or places. The message says what to try, usually a lower number, or two bunks at once.

It is taking a long time.

A whole session never takes more than 2 minutes, and that long only for a full camp. The panel says the most time that is left. If it is slow every time, close other programs, or other browser tabs with this page open. **Stop** keeps the weeks that are done.

A bunk ended up in the wrong village.

The village is the first letter of the bunk's name. A bunk called "Onondaga 3" is in Onondaga, and so is one called "Oak". A name that starts with TC is Taste of CSL, not Tusc.

A bunk has no grade or no camper count.

The app still works. Without a grade it goes by the bunk's place in its village, and without a count it assumes 12 campers.

I cannot change a bunk on the Build tab.

Bunks are changed on the Setup tab, in step 2. A change there is made in every week.

I cannot find Download all weeks, Upload or Reset.

Download all weeks and Upload are at the bottom of the Setup tab, under Files. Reset is in red at the top of Setup and in the week bar.

I refreshed the page during a run.

The run stops. The weeks that had already appeared are kept. Press Auto generate again for the rest.

I moved something on the calendar and it did not move on the schedule.

The calendar only fills empty periods. Clear the old one on the Build tab, then press **Put the calendar on the schedule now**.

Auto generate put a second Tiyul on.

It does not when the one you entered is labelled Tiyul. If you wrote it in under another name, the app cannot tell it is the Tiyul. Use the activity called Tiyul.

The schedule is gone.

The browser's saved data was cleared, or you are on a different browser or computer. Upload your last Excel file.

Something else.

Use **Contact support** at the bottom of the page.

11. Known limits

- **No login and no cloud.** The schedule is in one browser on one computer. Two people cannot work on it at once.
- **Two sessions.** Session 1 is four weeks and Session 2 is three. The dates are set for summer 2027 and cannot be changed on screen.
- **Sunday to Friday, four periods a day.** Saturday is not on the grid.
- **No phone layout.** The grid is wide. Use a laptop or desktop.
- **Day details** (R"H and LOD, TS, General Day, DOD, birthdays, EVP, notes) show on the Schedule tab but can only be edited in the Excel file.
- **The app does not know about weather, staffing or one-off events.** Enter those by hand, or add a line to the session calendar.
- **A day off for one bunk** cannot be put on the calendar. The calendar is for the whole camp or a whole village. Enter it by hand on the Build tab.
- **A bunk is the same in every week.** Its name, grades and campers cannot differ from one week to the next. The one exception is Taste of CSL, which is in week 1 of Session 2 only.
- **The how-often menu is on six rows,** not every one: Time with UH, Judaics, Israel, Teva, Yoga and added areas. The other areas are set by the week, exactly, or village by village.
- **In Session 2, Tusc's ropes is High Ropes.** That comes with the session and is not on the Settings tab.
- **A hand-entered period is trusted.** When building around what you entered, the app does not check your own entries against the sharing rules.
- **Undo** only covers the last Auto generate, and only until you change something.
- **27 bunks is the most.** The camp has 27 cabins.
- **A complete schedule cannot be promised for every setting.** The Settings tab lets you ask for more than fits. What is promised is that a run ends inside its time, that everything it puts on the schedule keeps the rules, and that it says "Not fully done" when periods are left empty.

12. Glossary

Term	Meaning
A&C	Arts and Crafts.
Bunk	One cabin group. A row on the schedule.
Village	A group of bunks of about the same age: Onondaga (O), Cayuga (C), Seneca (S), Mohawk (M), Tusc (T). The first letter of a bunk's name. The page calls a village by its name.
Period	One of the four activity slots in a day. Periods 1 and 2 are the morning, 3 and 4 the afternoon.
Double period	One activity across both periods of a morning or an afternoon.
Program area	What an activity counts toward on the Tracking tab. Low Ropes and High Ropes both count as Ropes.
Visit number	Which time this is for a bunk at an area, counted from the start of the session.
League	A village's own sports league: League (Onondaga), CHL (Cayuga), SSL (Seneca), MNL or MAL (Mohawk). Tusc has triathlon training instead.
Tiyul	A village's trip out of camp.
Hobbies	A half-day when the whole camp does chosen activities: AM Hobbies or PM Hobbies.
Time with UH	Time with the Unit Head.
Teva	The Teva program area.
Shabbat Prep	A village getting ready to lead Shabbat, run by the Music and Judaics specialists.
Mass Program (MP)	A program for the whole camp that takes the place of periods.
Village day	A day a village spends together instead of at periods: O-Day, C-Day and so on.
Color War (CW)	Two days of Session 2 with no periods.
Taste of CSL (TC)	Younger campers who come for the first week of Session 2.
Session calendar	The list, on the Settings tab, of everything in a session that is not a period.
Auto generate	The button that builds the periods for you.
Build around	Generating a week while keeping what is already on it.
Over a limit	A period, outlined in orange, where the app put one more bunk than a limit allows so that the week could be finished.
Light red (Tracking)	A bunk has fewer of an area than the Settings tab asks for.
Setup	The tab the page opens on: the session, its bunks, and its files.
Reset	The button that clears the periods, or puts the session back to its base template.

Base template	A session exactly as it starts: its own bunks, settings and calendar, with no periods filled in.
Not fully done	What the page says after a run when a week was left with empty periods.
Yellow period	An empty period that was cleared, by you or by Auto generate, and still needs filling.
Write-in	An activity you typed that is not in the list. It is kept, and not counted in Tracking.